System.

CAP HEIGHT TO BASELINE

OVERUSED GROTESK 600 · −3% TRACKING

BRAND & PRODUCT MANUAL

A blueprint for brands that start from type and grid, and add a logo, icons and pictures when they have them.

WEB · APPS · TYPE · MARKETING

SHEETS 00–18

00 SYSTEM · EDITION 1.0 · OFFSET, BLACK AND ONE SPOT COLOR, UNCOATED 120 G/M²

Contents

Every sheet is optional. Switch off what the client doesn’t bring, and the manual falls back to type and grid instead of leaving a hole.

02	Landing	WEB
03	Logo	IDENTITY
04	Color	IDENTITY
05	Display	IDENTITY
06	Text	IDENTITY
07	Mono	IDENTITY
08	Grid	LAYOUT
09	Icons	IDENTITY
10	Imagery	IDENTITY
11	Components	PRODUCT
12	Apps	PRODUCT
13	Motion	PRODUCT
14	Voice	WRITING
15	Marketing	MEDIA
16	Print	MEDIA
17	Downloads	FILES
18	Utility	WEB
00	Cover	↑

WITH / WITHOUT

SET AT SETUP

Logo	WITH WITHOUT
Icon set	WITH WITHOUT
Imagery	WITH WITHOUT

FALLBACKS

NEVER AN EMPTY SLOT

Each switch flips its sheets between the client’s assets and the template’s own fallback: a typographic wordmark for the logo, mono glyph cells for the icons, and drafting frames for the pictures.

Landing

One column of argument: a headline that says what it is, one action, then three reasons. The grid lines keep running behind it.

SYSTEM.EXAMPLE

System.

PRODUCT PRICING DOCS

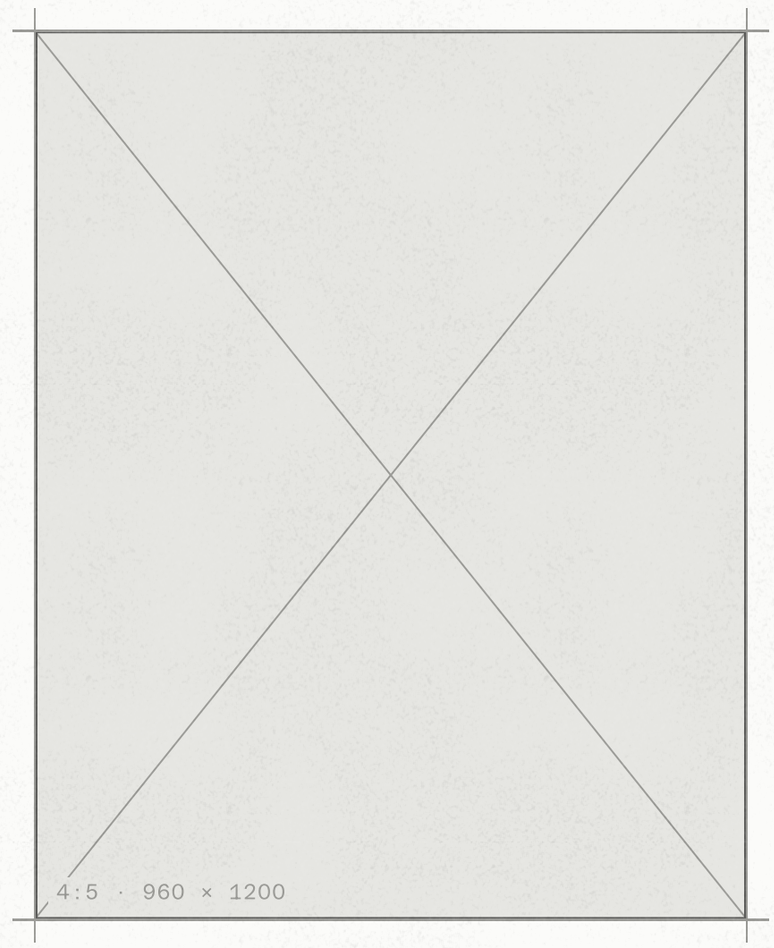
Sign in

Build the brand once, use it everywhere

Type, grid and color set up as one system, so the website, the app and the posters come out looking related.

Get the files

Read the manual



One source

Tokens live in one file. Change the accent there and every sheet updates.

Works without assets

No logo or icon set yet? Type and grid carry the identity until they arrive.

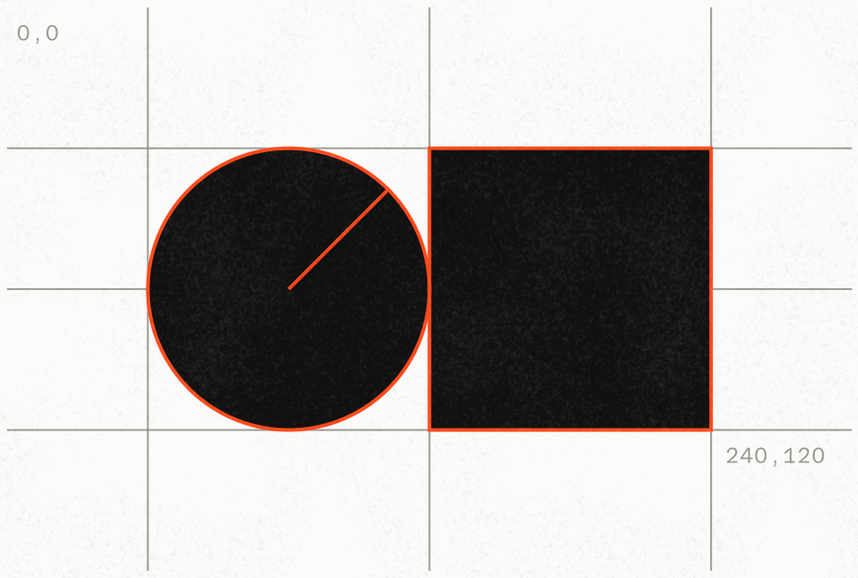
Ships as files

Logos, tokens and print PDFs come out of one script, ready to send.

Logo

The mark is a circle and a square of equal height. Keep half the mark height clear around the logo, and two thirds after the name, so the open end of the word balances the mark.

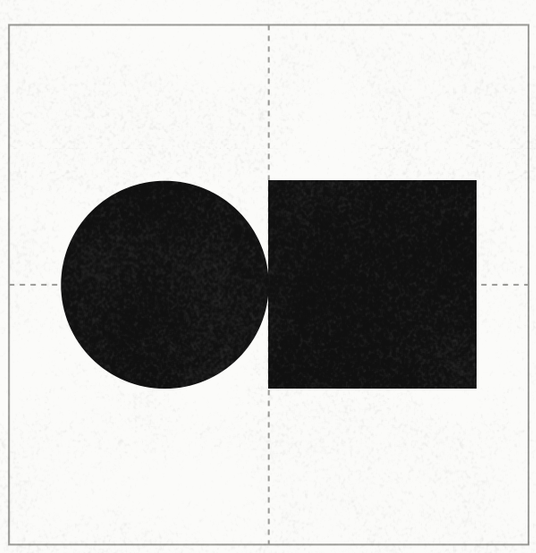
CONSTRUCTION — R = 1 UNIT



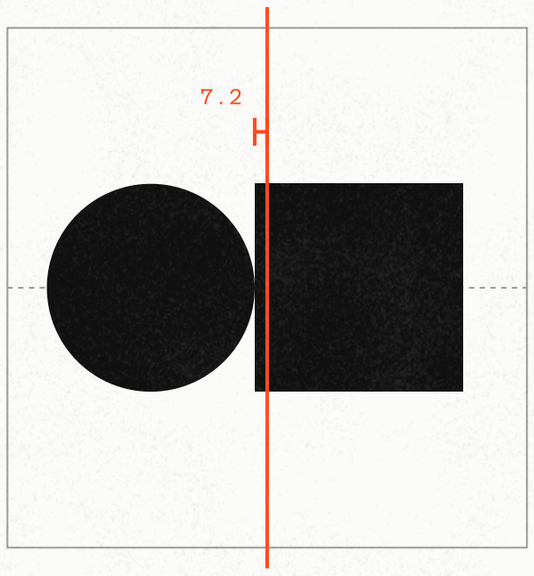
CLEAR SPACE — 1/2 AND 2/3 OF THE MARK HEIGHT



OPTICAL CENTER — SHIFT 7.2 = 3% OF THE WIDTH



Geometric center



Optical center · mass on the line

WHY — MARK ALONE

The square is heavier

It holds 14 400 units² against the circle's 11 310, so the mark's center of mass sits at 127.2 of its 240, not at 120.

Shift it 7.2 left

Wherever the mark stands alone and centered, on the splash, app icons and avatars, move it 3% of its width to the left, so the weight lands on the center.

Not in lockups

Next to the name the word balances it. Lockups align on their clear space instead.

LOCKUPS — MIN. 24 PX MARK

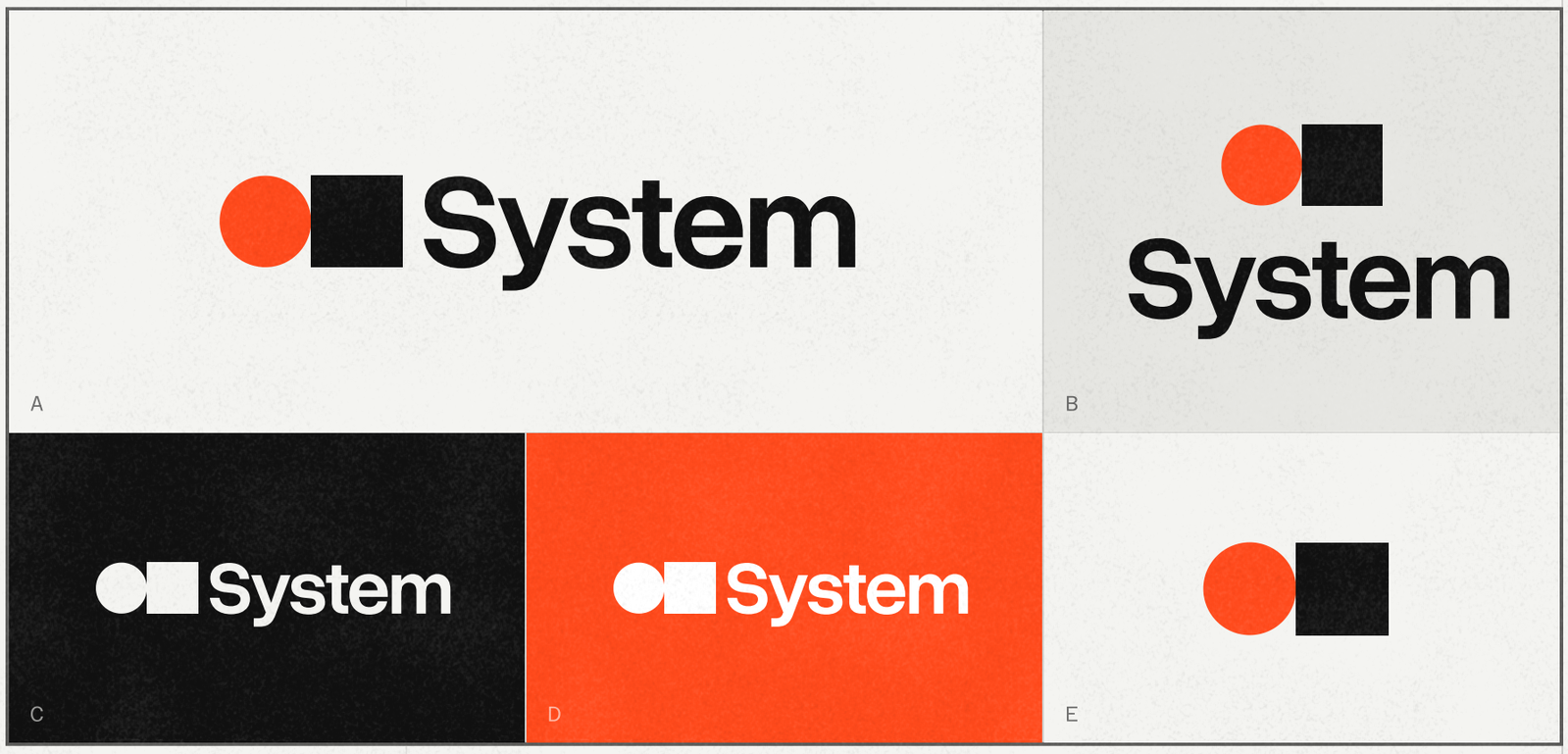
A **Primary.** Ink on paper. Use it wherever you can.

B **Stacked.** For square and narrow formats, avatars and stickers.

C **On ink.** Paper on the ink color, for dark screens and the back of cards.

D **Reversed.** White on the accent, once per spread at most.

E **Mark only.** When the name is already on screen, and below 120 px of lockup width.



Color

Paper, ink and three grays do the work. The accent is a drop: one key word, one active state, one full stop.

Paper

HEX	#F4F4F1
RGB	244 244 241
CMYK	0 0 1 4

Ink

HEX	#111111
RGB	17 17 17
CMYK	0 0 0 93

Gray 600

HEX	#5C5C5A
RGB	92 92 90
CMYK	0 0 2 64

Gray 400

HEX	#9A9A96
RGB	154 154 150
CMYK	0 0 3 40

Gray 100

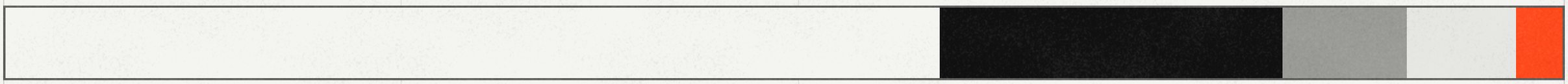
HEX	#E6E6E2
RGB	230 230 226
CMYK	0 0 2 10

Accent

HEX	#FF4A1C
RGB	255 74 28
CMYK	0 71 89 0

PROPORTION

PER LAYOUT, BY AREA



PAPER 60% · INK 22% · 8% · 7% · 3%

CONTRAST PAIRS

WCAG 2.2

INK ON PAPER — 17.4 — AAA

PAPER ON INK — 17.4 — AAA

GRAY 600 ON PAPER — 6.2 — AA

WHITE ON ACCENT — 3.3 — LARGE TEXT ONLY

Display

A Swiss neo-grotesk for headings and the name, with tight apertures and a tall x-height. Set it large and tight, and hand over to the text face below 20 px.

OVERUSED GROTESK — 300 – 600

Aa

RULES — 3

Horizontal terminals

C, G, S and the numerals cut off flat on the horizontal, so a tight headline locks onto the grid lines.

Large and tight

Tracking −3% from 32 px up, −1% below. Never smaller than 20 px.

Semibold is the name

Headings are medium. Semibold is kept for the name, so it stays the heaviest thing on the sheet.

SCALE — SIZE / LINE HEIGHT

DISPLAY	Start from type	72 / 72
H1	Start from type and grid	48 / 56
H2	Start from type and grid, then add the rest	32 / 40
H3	Start from type and grid, then add the logo and the rest	20 / 24

TYPE TESTER — 56 PX · 500

Hairlines, grids & a drop of color

SIZE WEIGHT

WEIGHTS — 4

Light	Regular
Medium	**Semibold**

Text

HANKEN GROTESK · 300 – 600

A plain grotesk for everything you read, from the lede to the small print. Open counters and an even stroke, so it holds up on uncoated paper and nothing fills in at 14 px.

HANKEN GROTESK — 300 – 600



SETTING — 16 / 24 · 60–75 CHARACTERS

A manual is read the way a brochure was: at arm’s length, a sheet at a time, often printed. So the text face does the quiet work. It sets the lede and the body, the captions and the small print, and never competes with the headings above it. Lines run 60 to 75 characters, paragraphs are split by space rather than indents, and the rag stays ragged.

Small print sets at 14 / 24 in the second ink, for notes and for captions under a picture.

SCALE — SIZE / LINE HEIGHT

LEDE	Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures.	20 / 32
BODY	Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures when the client has them.	16 / 24
SMALL	Start from type and grid, then add the logo, the icons and the pictures when the client has them.	14 / 24

INK — PRINTED, NOT RENDERED

Ink gain

Every letter carries a trace of spread, as ink does on uncoated paper: a hair heavier than the font. The PDF stays clean, the press adds its own.

Paper

The sheet carries a paper texture that scales with it: dark specks on the paper, light ones in the ink, which never quite covers the fibers.

WEIGHTS — 4

Light	Regular
Medium	**Semibold**

Mono

Azeret Mono for everything you measure: labels, values and code, like the lettering on a drawing. Courier Prime, set in italic like a typed note, for the one line on a sheet that should stand apart.

AZERET MONO — 300 – 400

Aa

i l m W O 1 { }

COURIER PRIME — 400 · ITALIC

Aa

i l m W O 1 { }

LETTERING — 2 TEMPLATES · 1 SIZE

LABEL	START FROM TYPE AND GRID	300 · 12 / 16
VALUE	#FF4A1C · 1440 × 900 · 8 px	300 · 12 / 24
CODE	--accent: #ff4a1c;	300 · 12 / 24

HIGHLIGHT — ONCE A SHEET

Start from type.

A special face

One line, a quote or a note in the margin, the way a brochure set one line in a face of its own. Never running text, never figures.

Grid

8 PX UNIT

Twelve columns on desktop, four on phones. The ruler lines behind this page are the grid itself, so anything off it shows.

COLUMNS

12 × FLUID · 24 GAP · 48 MARGIN



SPACING × 8 PX

S-1		8
S-2		16
S-3		24
S-5		40
S-8		64
S-12		96
S-16		128

BREAKPOINTS MIN WIDTH

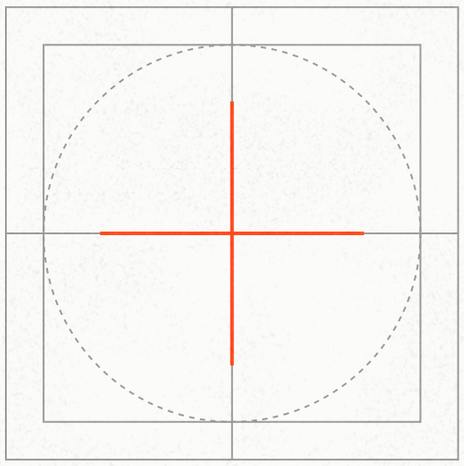
NAME	COLUMNS	GAP	WIDTH
Phone	4	16	0
Tablet	12	16	720
Desktop	12	24	1024
Wide	12	24	1440

Past 1440 the content stops growing. The ruler lines keep going to the edge of the screen.

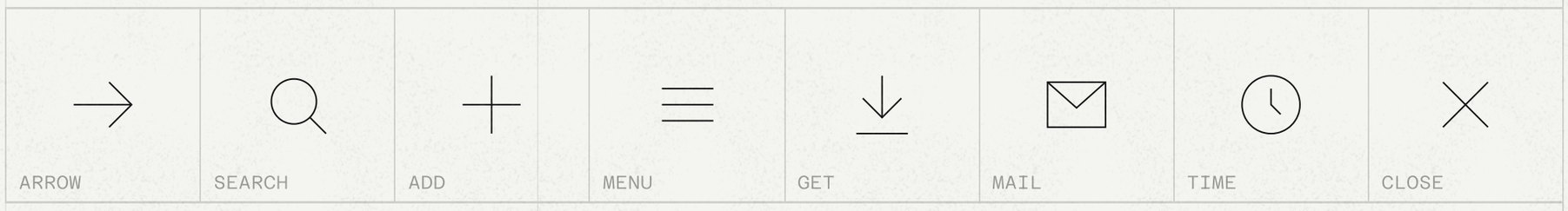
Icons

Icons are drawn on a 24 grid with a single 1 px hairline, open ends and no fills, so they sit with the ruler lines.

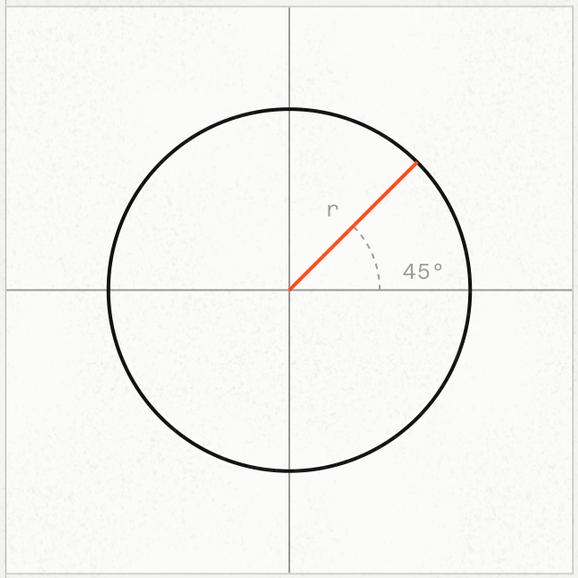
ANATOMY — 24 GRID

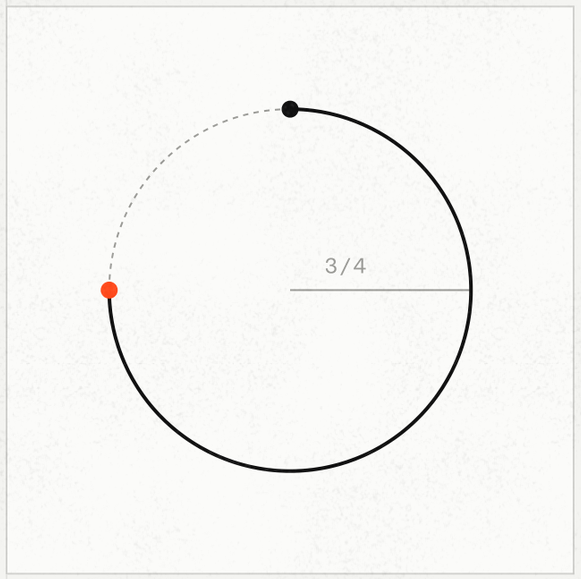


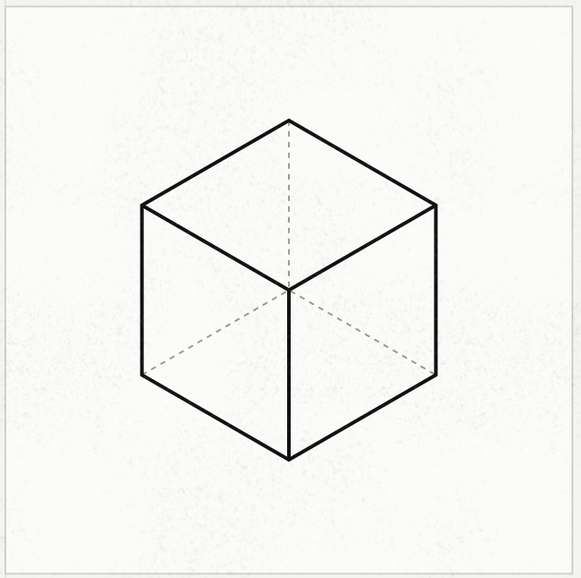
SET — 1 PX STROKE · 2 PX PADDING

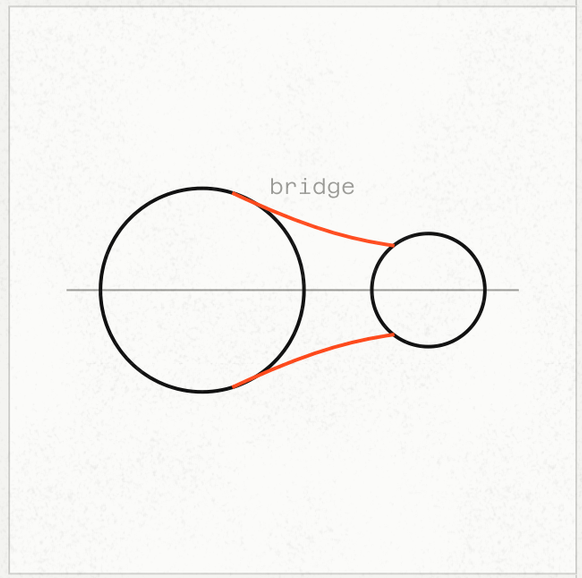


SKETCH SHAPES — ALWAYS AVAILABLE







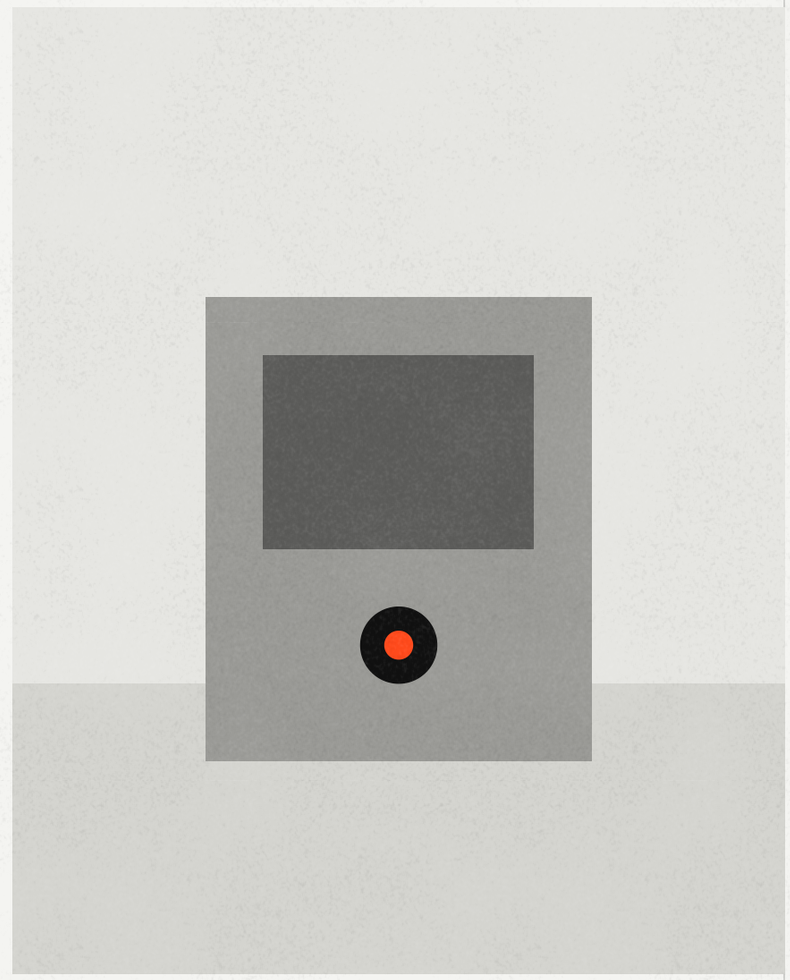


Imagery

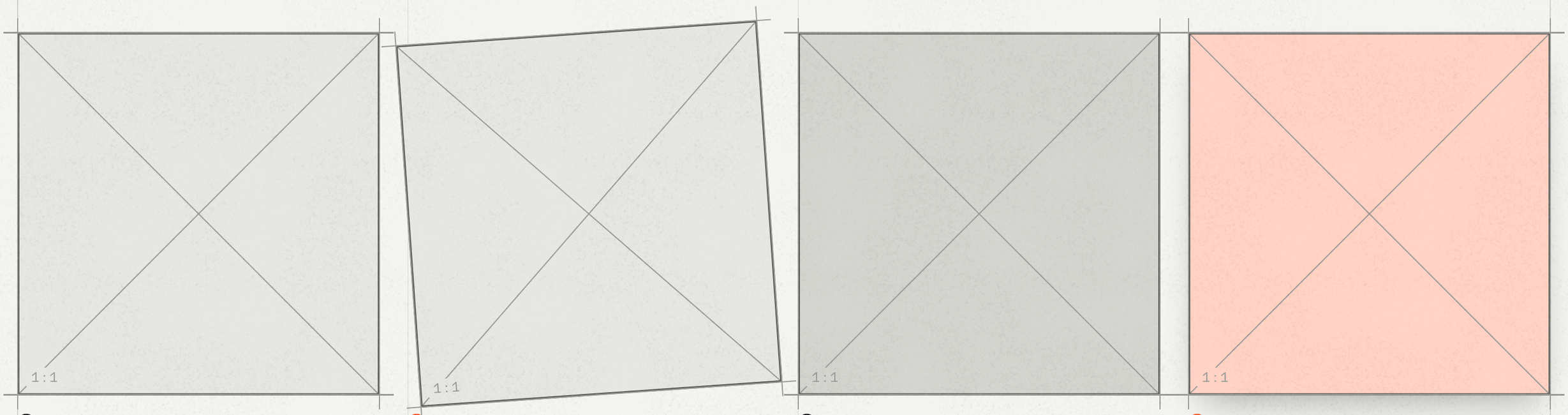
Pictures run in gray, flat and quiet. The accent may appear once per image, on the thing the picture is about.



GRAY FLAT · 16:9 · ACCENT ONCE



GRAY FLAT · 4:5 · OBJECT



Crop on the grid

Don’t tilt or skew

Gray, one accent at most

No tints or drop shadows

Components

Hairlines instead of boxes, pills for actions, and the accent saved for the one thing the screen wants you to do.

BUTTONS

48 / 32 PX

Primary Secondary Tertiary

Small Small Disabled

CHIPS & CHECKS

24 PX

SELECTED WEB APPS PRINT

☑ Logo ☑ Icons ☐ Imagery

FIELDS

UNDERLINE ONLY

NAME

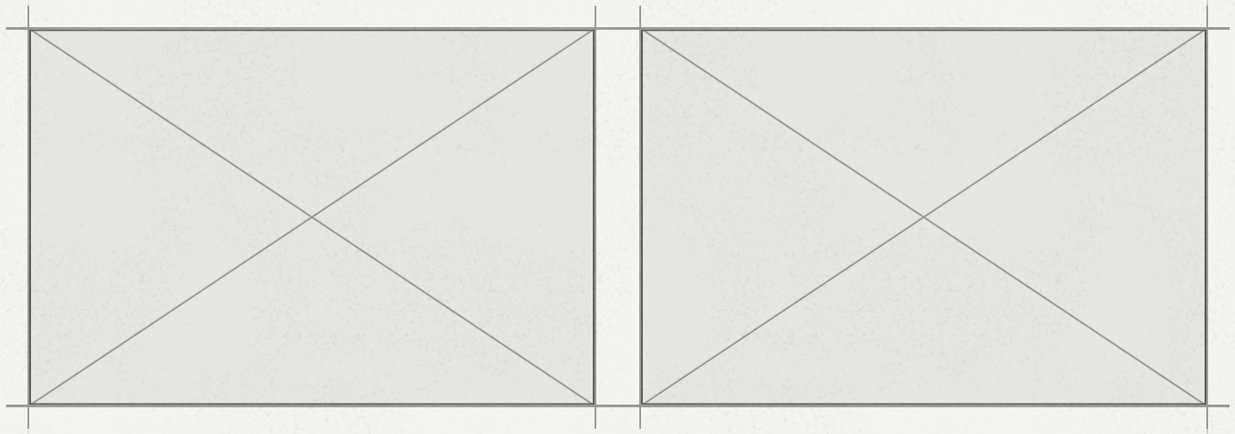
Your name

EMAIL · NEEDS AN @

hello.example.com

CARDS

TOP RULE, NO BOX



Case study

Short summary in two lines at most.

Release notes

What changed and why it matters.

TOKENS

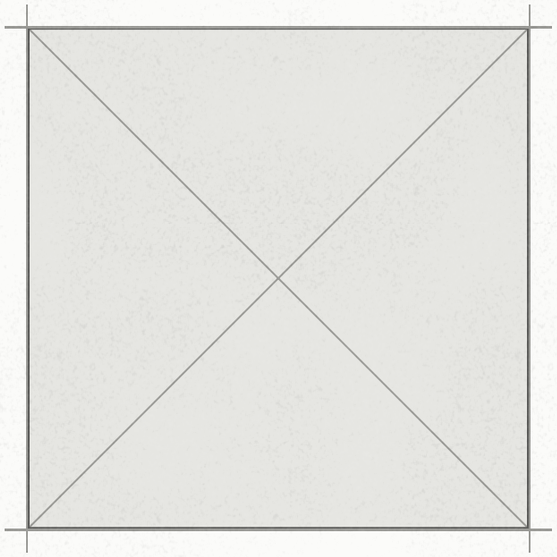
CSS/SYSTEM.CSS

TOKEN	VALUE	USE	DARK
--paper	#F4F4F1	Page background	#111110
--ink	#111111	Text, rules, primary fills	#EEEEEA
--ink-3	#9A9A96	Labels, annotations	#6B6B67
--fill	#E6E6E2	Drafting frames, skeletons	#222220
--accent	#FF4A1C	One thing per screen	#FF4A1C

Apps

Four states every app needs before it needs anything else: the welcome, the empty list, the wait and the error.

01 · WELCOME

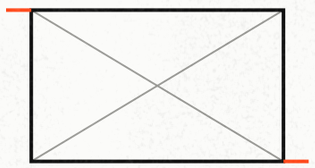


Everything in one place

Your files, your tokens and your manual, always in sync.

Get started

02 · EMPTY

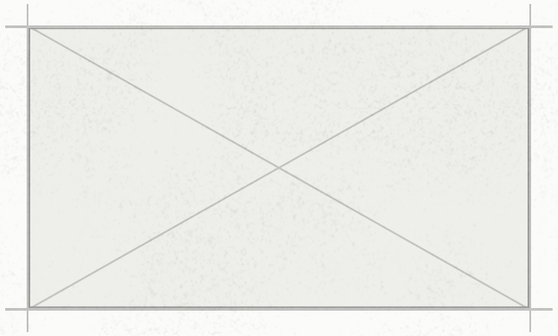


Nothing here yet

Add your first project and it will show up on this page.

Add a project

03 · LOADING





04 · ERROR

ERROR · E-104

We couldn’t reach the server

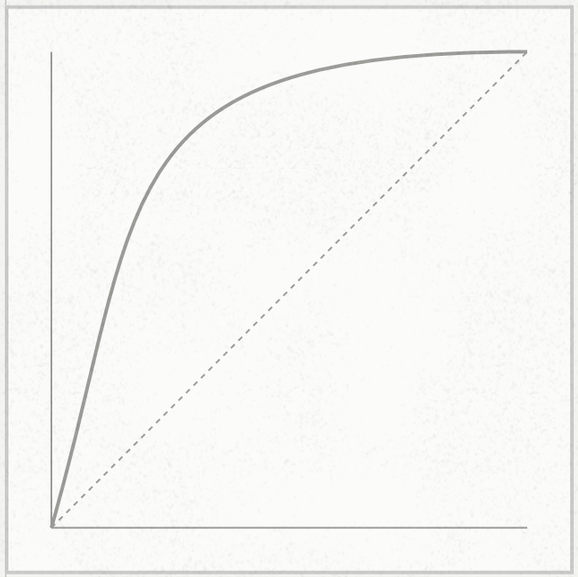
Check your connection and try again. Your changes are saved on this phone.

Try again

Motion

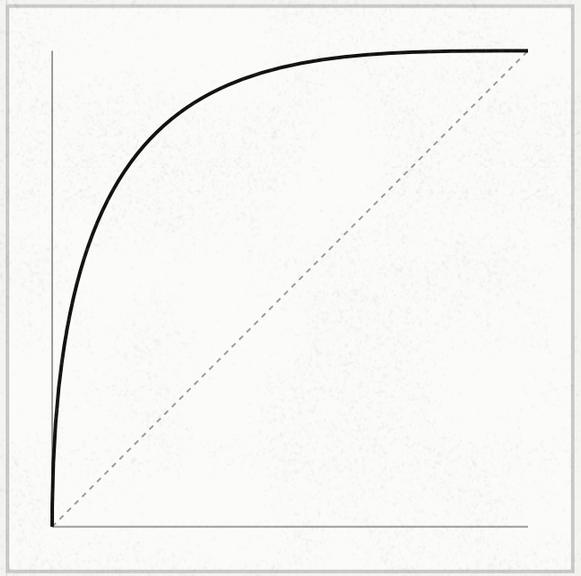
Things arrive fast and settle with a click, like a good switch. One curve for most of it, a detent for anything that toggles, and a spring for anything you drag.

STANDARD 240 MS



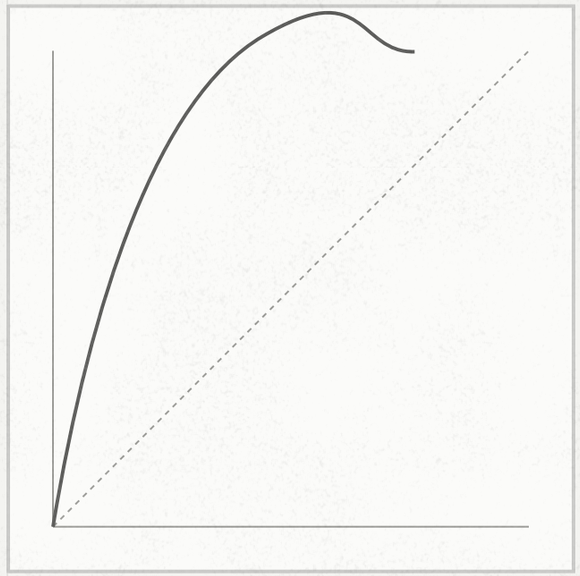
cubic-bezier(.2, .7, .1, 1)

ENTER 400 MS



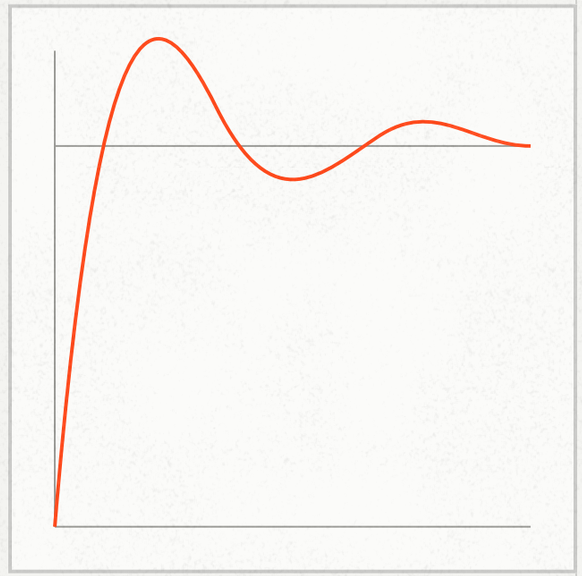
cubic-bezier(0, 0, .2, 1)

DETENT 320 MS



3% past the stop, then back

SPRING ≈ 560 MS



stiffness 320 · damping 22

Voice

Write the way the page looks: short, plain, nothing that doesn’t carry weight. Say what happened and what to do next.

Plain words

“Use”, not “leverage”. “Send”, not “submit”. If a word needs a tooltip, pick another one.

Sentence case

Headings, buttons and labels all start with one capital. Mono labels are the only capitals.

Verbs on buttons

A button says what it does: “Get the files”, never “OK” or “Click here”.

REWRITES

BEFORE → AFTER

BEFORE

~~Oops! Something went wrong. Please try again later.~~

AFTER

We couldn’t reach the server. Your changes are saved, so try again in a minute.

BEFORE

~~Unlock the power of seamless brand synergy today.~~

AFTER

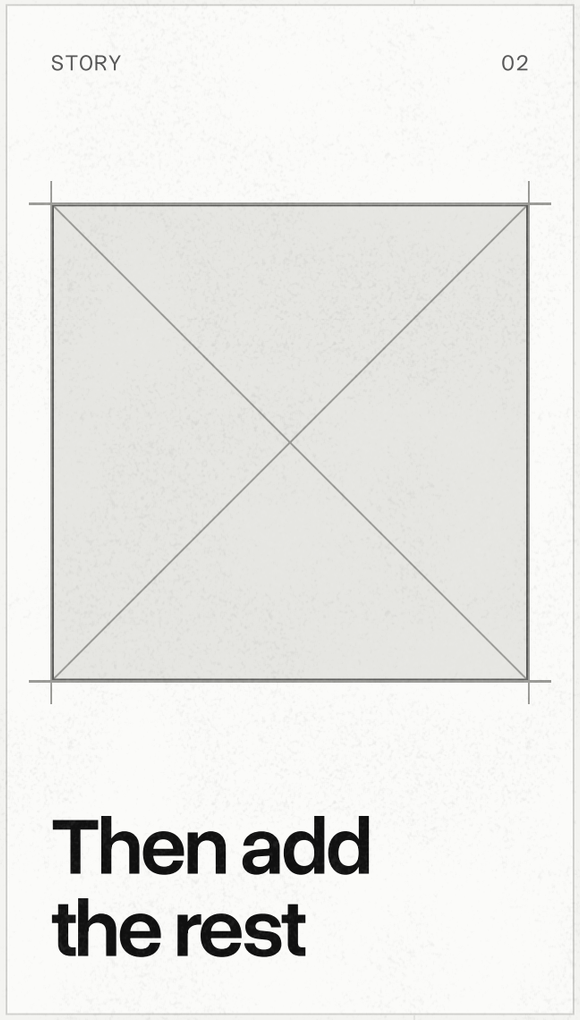
Keep the website, the app and the posters looking like one brand.

Marketing

The cover idea at every size: one big line of type, a label in the corner, and the accent on one thing.



POST · 1:1 · 1080 × 1080



STORY · 9:16 · 1080 × 1920



LINK PREVIEW · 1.91:1 · 1200 × 630

Build the brand once, use it everywhere

Get the files

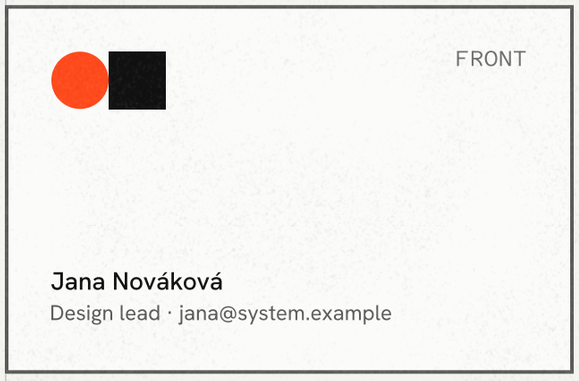
LEADERBOARD · 728 × 90

Print

Cards and letterheads use the same grid, scaled to millimeters. Uncoated paper, one ink plus the accent.

BUSINESS CARD

85 × 55 MM

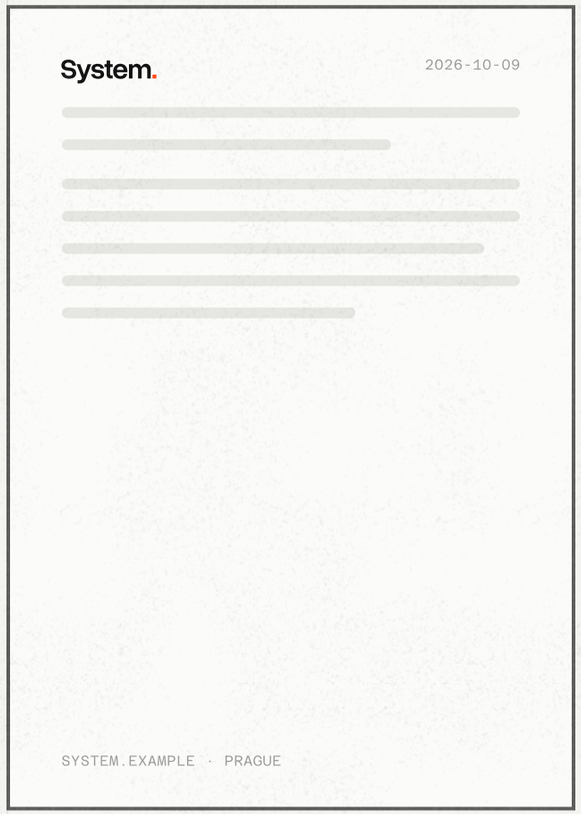


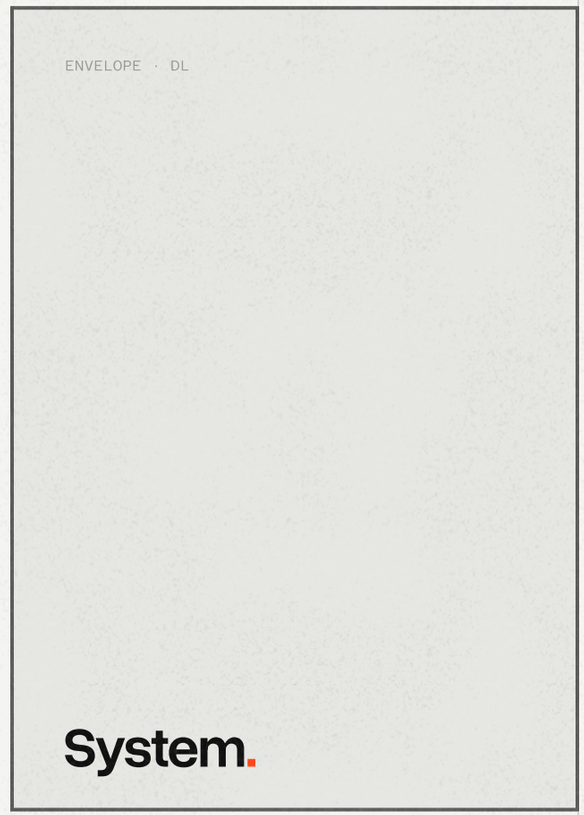


Front in ink on uncoated white, back flooded in ink. The name is the only line set larger than 12 pt.

LETTERHEAD

A4 · 210 × 297 MM





Downloads

Everything on these pages as files, built by one script. Hand over the link and you never send a logo by email again.

Logo package SVG, PNG and PDF, every lockup, clear space built in	ZIP	2.4 MB	Download
Design tokens Color, type and spacing as CSS variables and JSON	CSS · JSON	8 KB	Download
Fonts Overused Grotesk, Hanken Grotesk, Azeret Mono and Courier Prime, all under the OFL	TTF · WOFF2	1.1 MB	Download
This manual The whole manual as one file, fonts embedded	PDF · HTML	8.5 MB	Download

Utility

The pages nobody designs. They get the same grid and the same voice, and they always offer a way back.

NOT FOUND — 404.HTML

404

This page moved or never existed. The cover is a good place to start again.

Back to the cover

FAVICON — FAVICON.SVG · 32 GRID



SYSTEM. — EDITION 1.0

CHANGELOG — NEWEST FIRST

1.0	First edition. Sheets 00 to 18, the with/without switches, light and dark.
0.2	The ferrofluid nav, drafting frames and the gray illustration style.
0.1	Tokens, the 8 px grid and the infinite ruler lines.

RULES — LIGHT AND DARK TABS

The mark in a black disc

The circle in the accent, the brand’s dot, and the square in white, on a disc of ink. The disc carries it on light tab strips and dark ones alike, so the icon never follows the system theme.

Optically centered

The mark is 12 units tall on the 32 grid and 24 wide, as large as the disc allows with an even margin, and sits 3% of its width left of center, like the mark alone anywhere else.

SET IN OVERUSED GROTESK, HANKEN GROTESK & AZERET MONO

BACK TO TOP ↑